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◆ The ill omen.

Muromachi Japan. Three hosts possessed by shikigami have one year to live—and one chance: to climb Mount Gokumon and slay the god sealed beneath it. CAVE's Guwange as the arcade board ran it, with Coin-Op Game Studio's OMEN arrangement—coin chains popped cluster by cluster, and Kyocho's double-or-nothing grazes—and the two arcade programs before it.



GUWANGE © ATLUS / CAVE 1999. OMEN arranged by COIN-OP GAME STUDIO. For the Nintendo 64 with the Expansion Pak. Made from your own ROM images; not for sale.

GUWANGE

OMEN

INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

取扱説明書

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OMEN arranged by COIN-OP GAME STUDIO, 2026.

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GUWANGE : OMEN

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NOTES

覚書

GUWANGE, 1999

THE LEGEND

物語

Japan, in the Muromachi era. Across the provinces men and women are taken by **shikigami**—spirits that give their hosts a terrible power, and kill them one year to the day after they were possessed.

There is a legend. Under Mount Gokumon—the Gate of Hell—is sealed **Guwange**, a malevolent god. A host who takes the talismans of the five elements from the five demons that guard them, and then slays Guwange, will be set free. Three hosts set out for the mountain.



Shishin

and RIKIOU

Thirty-five. He hides behind an oni mask and never speaks, and fights with kunai. Rikiou, five hundred years old and more, keeps his host alive —for as long as Shishin kills men for him to devour.



Hiiragi Kosame

and YATSUHISHA

Seventeen, a shrine maiden of a family of demon hunters, who fights with the bow. Her shikigami is Yatsuhisha, a fox spirit of two hundred years.



Kamono Gensuke

and KIRINMARU

Fifteen, an apothecary's apprentice turned bounty hunter. Kirinmaru, his shikigami, is a bloodthirsty tengu of three hundred years.

The hero is chosen on the PLAYER SELECT screen; each fights in their own way, with their own shikigami.

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GETTING STARTED

準備

Guwange: Omen is CAVE's 1999 arcade game as the arcade board ran it, here on the Nintendo 64—with Coin-Op Game Studio's OMEN arrangement, the two arcade programs before it, and a host menu of its own.

What you need

- A Nintendo 64, NTSC or PAL, with the **Expansion Pak** (8 MB). Without it the game shows EXPANSION PAK REQUIRED and stops.
- A flash cart that loads a 58 MB ROM: **EverDrive 64 X7**, **SummerCart64** or **64drive**.
- **guwange_omen.z64**, built from your own copy of the arcade ROMs (**bash port/build_all.sh**). It holds the game's data: it is for your own use and not for passing on.
- A controller in port 1 (player 1 and the host menu); a second in port 2 for player 2.

Installing

Copy the ROM to the cart's SD card. Its save type is **EEPROM 16K**, and its header says so; if your cart's menu asks, or saves do not stay, choose EEPROM 16K for it by hand.

> 覚書 NOTE
> With EEPROM 4K only OMEN's settings and scores are saved (the MODE item then says EEPROM 4K: ONLY OMEN IS SAVED). A save from the earlier 4K ROMs is OMEN's data in this one.

NOTES

覚書

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IF SOMETHING IS WRONG 対処

EXPANSION PAK REQUIRED	Switch off, insert the Expansion Pak, switch on.
Settings and scores are not kept	Choose the save type EEPROM 16K for the game in your cart's menu.
The sound breaks	Choose SPEED: ARCADE: it leaves the console 4 % more time a frame.
A score was not saved	Practice runs and credits played with INVULNERABLE on are never saved (the score lock).
The game freezes	Run **guwange_omen_validate.z64** the same way: it stops on a screen that names what went wrong. **guwange_omen_diag.z64** shows the console's live figures at the top of the picture. A photograph of either says what happened. After a freeze switch the console off and on: its RESET button does not reset the graphics chip.
A black picture in an emulator	Use ares (with the Expansion Pak and a low-level RDP). High-level graphics plugins cannot draw it.

CREDITS 制作

GUWANGE
© ATLUS / CAVE 1999.

OMEN
Made by COIN-OP GAME STUDIO.

◆ Starting



Start the game from the cart's menu. After the WARNING screen comes **COIN-OP GAME STUDIO**'s splash; START or A cuts it short.

There are **no coins**: the board is always in its own **FREE PLAY**, so the screen does not say so. START starts a game from the title or the attract, and continues one when it ends: each player may continue as many times as the host menu's **CONTINUES** allows (3, 5 or 7; 3 at first). After the last continue, the next life lost ends the game.

In OMEN the attract plays: the high scores, the title, the story and a demonstration. START at any moment of it starts a game. (ORIGINAL and SPECIAL, as their boards did, wait on the title instead.)

CONTROLS 操作

N64 CONTROLLER	IN THE GAME
Control stick or D-pad	Move
A	Shot. **Hold** it: the shikigami
B	Bomb
Z	Button 3 (the board's C button)
C▼	Autofire, when AUTOFIRE is on in the host menu
START	Start a game; continue one
L + R **together**	Open and close the host menu

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Controller 1 is player 1, controller 2 player 2: player 2 joins or continues with START on controller 2. The stick has a dead zone of about a quarter of its travel. There is no coin button.

In the host menu: UP / DOWN select, LEFT / RIGHT change, A chooses, B or L + R closes. The board's own TEST MODE is driven with the stick, A (choose / change) and B (default).

> **心得 TIP**
> Holding A and the shikigami come out; tapping it fires. Use C▼, the autofire, when you want a stream of shots without calling the shikigami.

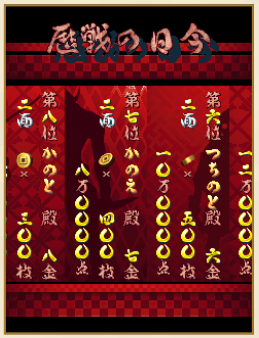
SAVES

WHAT IS KEPT

The cartridge's EEPROM 16K keeps the host settings and MODE, and for each program the board's own TEST MODE settings and its high-score table: all ten ranks, with score, name, coins and stage.

The table is saved when a name entry ends—unless the score lock holds—and put back at every power-on. Changes are written in the background, a little each frame, so the game never stops for them. A blank or damaged save gives the factory settings, in free play.

> **覚書 NOTE**
> In ares the save is **<rom>.eeprom** beside the ROM. To move an old 4K save to a cart that starts a fresh 16K one, pad it: **python port/tools/save16k.py OLD.eep NEW.eep**.



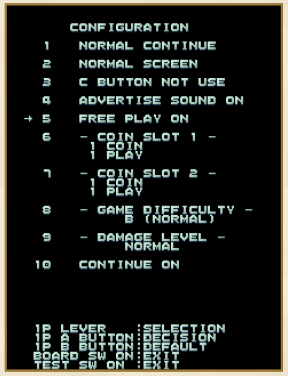
The high-score table, kept for each program.

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THE BOARD'S SERVICE MENU

TEST MODE

試験



TEST MODE, in the host menu, opens the arcade board's own service menu: CONFIGURATION, INPUT CHECK and SOUND CHECK.

In CONFIGURATION A steps the value under the cursor and B restores every default. Choose TEST MODE in the host menu again to leave: the board keeps its settings and restarts into the title.

ITEM	VALUES (FACTORY FIRST)	HERE
1 CONTINUE	NORMAL / DISCOUNT	No effect in free play
2 SCREEN	NORMAL / REVERSE	Turns the board's picture upside down
3 C BUTTON	NOT USE / USE	Button 3 (Z)
4 ADVERTISE SOUND	ON / OFF	The attract's sound
5 FREE PLAY	ON	**Always on**: it cannot be changed
6, 7 COIN SLOT	1 COIN 1 PLAY ...	No effect: there are no coins
8 GAME DIFFICULTY	B (NORMAL) / A (EASY) / C (HARD) / D (VERY HARD)	
9 DAMAGE LEVEL	NORMAL / EASY / VERY EASY / HARD	How much a hit takes
10 CONTINUE	ON / OFF	OFF: no continues. ON: as many as the host menu's CONTINUES

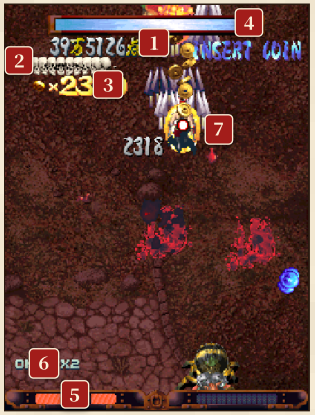
Each program keeps its own settings. Guwange has no lives setting: a hero has a life gauge, and DAMAGE LEVEL sets how much a hit takes from it.

HOW TO PLAY

遊戯

The stage scrolls up the screen. Fight your way through it, collect what falls, and defeat its boss—six stages, six bosses, the fifth stage a castle taken from the outside and then the inside.

The screen



1. The score
2. The skull meter: ten skulls at most
3. The gold chain: the coins linked
4. The boss's gauge
5. Your life gauge
6. OMEN X2: Kyocho running (OMEN)
7. Your hero, with the shikigami's barrier

Shot, shikigami and bomb

Shot
Tap A to fire. Enemies the shot kills fill the skull meter.

Shikigami
Hold A and your shikigami comes out to fight where you guide it. Enemy bullets it touches slow down and turn pink. While it is out a barrier halves the damage of a hit.

Bomb
B sends out an energy blast that clears the bullets it touches. Bombs are few—you hold at most five.

Life
Each hit takes from your life gauge (how much is TEST MODE's DAMAGE LEVEL). Recovery items—small, medium, full—give it back.

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◆ Coins, the chain and the skulls

Guwange is scored in **coins**. Coins fall from what you destroy, and every coin taken while the chain lives adds to the **gold chain**—the longer the chain, the more each coin is worth.

The chain lives as long as the **skull meter** does. Destroying things fills it, ten skulls at most; it drains all the time. **When it empties, the chain is gone.** Losing a life halves it.

The shikigami is the way to big chains: the bullets it slows are turned into coins when it destroys the enemy that fired them.

Grazing

With the shikigami out and six skulls or more, bullets that pass close to you—**grazes**—each pay a coin. The more skulls, the wider the zone.

SKULLS	GRAZE SQUARE, SHIKIGAMI OUT
0 - 5	no grazing
6	42 x 42 px
7	48 x 48 px
8	54 x 54 px
9	60 x 60 px
10	66 x 66 px

Your hitbox is a 6 x 6 pixel square; a graze is any bullet whose center is inside the square around it. With the shikigami in, only a full meter grazes, and slowed bullets cannot be grazed at all.



TATE A: as the turned TV shows it.



YOKO: upright on an unturned TV.

Which to choose: TATE if you can turn the TV. Otherwise YOKO 480I where 480i looks good, YOKO 240P on a CRT or a 240p-friendly upscaler. A change takes effect at once (the picture pauses a moment while the TV resyncs).

◆ Speed, PAL and NTSC

SMOOTH runs one game frame a TV frame: smooth scrolling, the game and its sound about 4 % faster than the arcade's 57.55 Hz on an NTSC console. **ARCADE** runs the board at its own rate and shows the latest picture at each TV frame. If the console cannot keep up the sound comes first; should it still break in SMOOTH, choose ARCADE.

On a **PAL** console ARCADE is the default (the game at its own speed, about one picture in five not shown); SMOOTH there runs the game 13 % slower than the arcade. The YOKO modes use PAL's 288 lines.

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SCREEN AND SPEED

THE SCREEN

The arcade's monitor stood on its side, and the game's picture is made for it. SCREEN, in the host menu, shows it on a TV four ways. Every way, the host menu and the splash read upright.

Turning the TV

SCREEN	THE TV	THE PICTURE
TATE A (default)	Turned 90° counter-clockwise: its top edge on your **left**	Every arcade pixel a TV pixel: the sharpest
TATE B	Turned 90° clockwise: its top edge on your **right**	The same, turned the other way
YOKO 240P	Upright, as it is	The game stood up in the middle, bars at the sides. Progressive, no flicker; a little soft (320 lines into 240)
YOKO 480I	Upright, as it is	Every line kept, over 480 interlaced lines: more detail, a slight flicker on a CRT

THE ARRANGEMENT

THE OMEN RULES

OMEN is Coin-Op Game Studio's arrangement of Guwange's Blue Label version. The meter is harder to fill and easier to keep; grazing and canceling are how you feed it—and a full meter opens Kyocho, the ill omen.

Kyocho: OMEN X2

With the shikigami out and all **ten skulls** full, your next graze starts Kyocho. **OMEN X2** appears above your life gauge and the ground darkens to a deep red-brown.

- Every graze pays **double** coins.
- It lasts 2.5 seconds. Each graze adds a sixth of a second, a slowed bullet's a third, up to 5 seconds.
- The sign blinks in its last second. If it runs out you **lose two skulls**.
- Let go of A and it ends at once, with no loss.



Kyocho running: the ground in red-brown, OMEN X2 above the life gauge.

Local cancels and pop chains

A shikigami kill no longer turns every slowed bullet on screen into coins—only those near the enemy that died (56 pixels around it). Tag separate clusters, graze them, then **pop** each one by destroying an enemy beside it.

Pops chain: another pop within 1.5 seconds is chain 2, then 3, and on. Each chained pop adds bonus coins: the bullets canceled times (chain - 1), up to 20 a pop. A pop that cancels nothing neither breaks nor extends the chain.

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The meter, rebalanced

Shot kills
Half a skull (Blue Label gave a whole one). Grazing and canceling are the main ways to fill it.

Grazing holds it
After any graze the meter cannot drain for half a second, and each graze puts a little back.

Half-speed drain
The rest of the time the meter drains half as fast as Blue Label's.

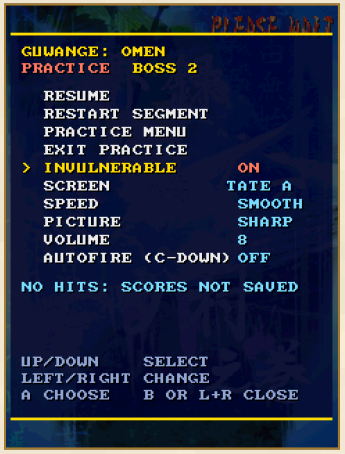
Tagged bullets pay
A slowed bullet's graze gives three coins and twice the meter of an ordinary one.

Cancel bursts
Every bullet a shikigami kill cancels puts meter back; bursts of 10 and of 25 pay a bonus, up to three skulls.

The hitbox marker
A white dot ringed in red on your hero: the white is your real 6 x 6 hitbox.

OMEN also dresses the three heroes and their shikigami in its crimson, turns the title's forest maroon, and adds its logo and the studio's splash and credits. Everything else is Blue Label as it was.

During a practice run



The heading says PRACTICE and the segment. The items are RESUME, **RESTART SEGMENT**, **PRACTICE MENU**, **EXIT PRACTICE**, then INVULNERABLE and the picture and sound items. TEST MODE, RESET GAME, the resets and MODE wait until the practice is left.

Reset scores and settings

It asks first: NO is highlighted (B is NO); LEFT / RIGHT pick THIS MODE or ALL MODES. The board then restarts with the factory's settings—still in free play.

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SPEED SMOOTH / ARCADE	SMOOTH: one game frame a TV frame. ARCADE: the board's own 57.55 Hz (the next chapter).
PICTURE SHARP / SOFT	The video interface's filtering: SOFT blends the picture slightly.
VOLUME 8 (0 - 10)	The sound's volume.
AUTOFIRE (C-DOWN) OFF / 30 HZ / 15 HZ	C▼ fires repeatedly.
CONTINUES 3 / 5 / 7	How many times each player may continue a game. After the last one, that player's next life lost ends their game.
TEST MODE	The board's own service menu (a later chapter). Chosen again, it leaves it: the board saves its settings and restarts.
RESET GAME	Restarts the board, as a power cycle; the saves are kept.
RESET SCORES AND SETTINGS NO / THIS MODE / ALL MODES	The high scores and TEST MODE's settings back to the factory's, for the running program or all three; the host's settings to their defaults (MODE is kept).
PRACTICE	The practice list: a stage or a boss of the running program.
INVULNERABLE OFF / ON	No hits. Off at power-on, never saved; the credit's scores are then not saved.
MODE OMEN / ORIGINAL 1999 / SPECIAL	The program the board runs. Asks NO / YES; YES restarts the board in it.

MODE

THREE PROGRAMS 三本

The host menu's **MODE** chooses which arcade program the board runs. Each keeps its own high scores and its own TEST MODE settings; everything else is shared.



ORIGINAL 1999



SPECIAL



OMEN

ORIGINAL 1999 Master Ver., 1999 6/24	CAVE's first release of Guwange.
SPECIAL (BLUE LABEL) Special Ver., 2000 7/7	The Blue Label version of 2000, whose title is blue—the program OMEN is made on.
OMEN v2.8, the default	Coin-Op Game Studio's arrangement (the previous chapter).

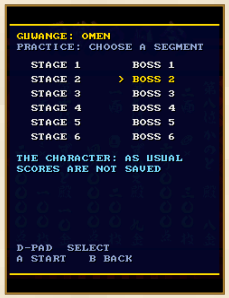
Choosing another asks first (NO / YES); YES restarts the board in that program, from its own power-on. ORIGINAL and SPECIAL are their arcade programs unchanged: they draw no hitbox marker, and wait on the title between games.

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AND INVULNERABLE

PRACTICE

Play one stage, or one boss, of the running program—as often as you like.



The practice list.

1. Open the host menu and choose **PRACTICE**.
2. Choose a segment: **STAGE 1 - 6** or **BOSS 1 - 6**.
3. The board powers on unseen and the PLAYER SELECT comes up: pick your hero as usual.
4. The run starts at the stage's own start, or a few seconds before the boss.

When the stage or the boss is cleared, or the life is gone, the game holds under a prompt: **RESTART SEGMENT** (exactly the same start again: the same hero, the same everything), **PRACTICE MENU** (another segment) or **EXIT PRACTICE** (the board powers on: WARNING, splash, attract). A chooses.

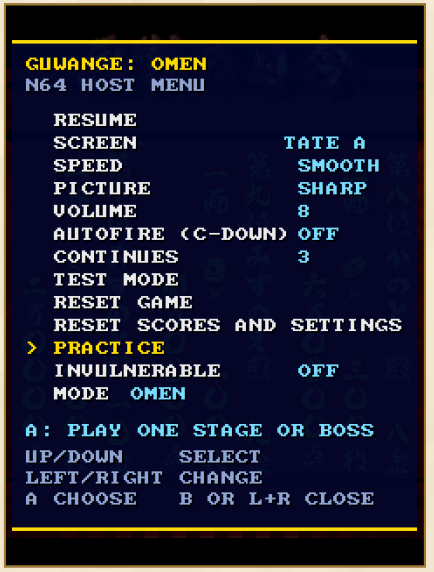
◆ Invulnerable

INVULNERABLE makes your hero impossible to hit (the hero shows the game's own shield). It can be turned on at any time, in a practice run or out of one; it is off at power-on and never saved.

> 注意 CAUTION
> **The score lock.** A practice run never saves a score, and neither does a credit during which INVULNERABLE was on, even for a moment. The menu's heading says so (THIS GAME'S SCORES: NOT SAVED). The next credit with it off is saved as usual.

THE HOST MENU

Press L + R at any time—in play, in the attract, in TEST MODE, over the splash. The game is paused, the sound muted, the picture dimmed behind the panel. UP / DOWN select (they wrap round), LEFT / RIGHT change, A chooses, B or L + R closes. A choice is applied at once and saved.



The host menu. The line under the items says what the one selected does.

RESUME	Back to the game.
SCREEN TATE A / TATE B / YOKO 240P / YOKO 480I	How the picture is shown: the TV turned one way or the other, or upright (the next chapter).